

ZONING FOR SUCCESS / Phil, the Odious Boss

Dora exited the SubT one stop earlier, ~~on the~~ Spierinxhoorn, where, just opposite the soccer fields, she was greeted with an iron gate picturing Our Dear Leader. Dustin, beckoning the proles from the past to step into the glorious future. She wanted time to reflect on how she might be greeted at work, and anticipate some glib remarks or retorts. She hoped that the HR could be relied on to have informed her workplace, and Phil, that conniving, wormtongue mouthbreather of a creature, to something that was halfway credible. Last year he had threatened her @ at the Xday party - hunching too close to her, his vile breath from a long neglected halitosis curdling the very air, and his bloodshot eyes from the nitrogen dioxide emissions from the ongoing revamped interest in burning fossil fuels after the collapse of CERN and ITER due to right-wing extreme governments (called lenient left-leaning in the post-Dustin era) - research facilities with the purge of scientists and the crimping of funding and the vilification of general intelligentia. Put to work shoveling open-pit lithium mines in the Chinese Congo. indeed. Their fate made Dora shudder, and she made sure not to appear too smart in any public address.

55! -- maybe make this a dialogue --)

She walked speedily along the verge of the crumbling pavement, the EVs and rickety fat-bikes speeding or trundling by. The wind was in her back, now coming due west, and snow was starting to flurry in corners.

She hoped that her colleague XXX? or Erwin would be there to deflect Phil's stinging barbs. He would feel he had been sheated out of dealing her a bunch of neg points - quite the target for him. Once upon a time Phil must have not had those eyebrows

! -- example of altercation --

Dora had just finished writing up and retrowiping the history of EAS, the European Space Agency. It was just in time for the morning chickory break at half past ten o'clock, and she was yearning for a cup of the bitter brew. She beckoned to fellow cognitariat chica, Tricia, who specialised in deep fakes of trolls and govt. officials. Her eyes were habitually bloodshot on Monday mornings, indicating a voluntary pollution of the lungs with skif or the like. They had warmed to each other within a few weeks of Dora's assignment, and in fact, Molly was a friend of Tricia, who had introduced the two at a celebration at work in accordance with the annulment of a section of Civil law (pertaining to the rights of asylum seekers, abortionists and victims of incel violence). Although it was worrying, the reasoning was that these population ultra-minorities had all but disappeared with the entrenching of the Ruling Party (aptly named) since the last decade, so to ease the strain on govt and reduce costs, a massive effort had started from the get-go of prime-president-minister, Dustin